

TALISMANS ON FIRE

As Liverpool's Mohamed Salah continued his **fiery form**, Luka Modric rolled back the years with an excellent strike for Real Madrid.

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There are seasons when a team's football is so ruthless and pristine that victory is inevitable. In the last four seasons, Pep Guardiola's Manchester City has been that team in English top-flight football, but the 2024-25 season has belonged to Arne Slot and his well-oiled Liverpool side.

In its latest win, Liverpool beat defending champion Man City 2-0 to go 11 points clear at the top of the table, making it the overwhelming favourite to win its 20th Premier League title.

This team might lack the flair and the swashbuckling nature often associated with the Jurgen Klopp era, but Slot's Liverpool is effective and can churn out results even on bad days — something champion teams tend to do.

Against Man City, Liverpool took its chances, as Pep Guardiola's men enjoyed more possession and had more shots on target. Leading the Reds' charge was its Egyptian talisman Salah (**left**), who scored a goal and set up Dominik Szoboszlai for the second.

In doing so, he became the first player in Premier League history to score and assist in both matches against the reigning champion in a single season.

Salah's pass for Szoboszlai was his 11th away assist of the season, a

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